Grip or glide? The surface challenge · Pupil Resources

Learning goal: I can explain how friction acts between touching surfaces and judge when grip or glide is useful.

Arrival Questions (In your book)

1. Name a push or a pull you used today.

2. Which two surfaces touch when a shoe walks on a floor?

3. Which way does friction act on a box sliding right?

4. Can you ask an adult to clarify a diagram?

Starter Question

A brake pad presses against a turning bicycle wheel. Would less friction help it stop?

A. No. Friction between the pad and wheel resists sliding and slows the wheel.

B. Yes. Less friction makes the brake grip tighter.

C. Friction does not act on a moving wheel.

Method Strip

1. Place the surface scenario cards and texture strips flat on the desk.

2. Identify the two touching surfaces in each scenario. STOP AND CHECK with your adult.

3. Draw a block sliding right in your book and add a labelled friction arrow pointing left.

4. Choose one example where friction helps and one where friction is unhelpful.

5. Write a sentence for each naming both touching surfaces and why friction helps or hinders.

Exit Ticket

Which way does friction point when a block slides right?

Name two touching surfaces where high friction is helpful.

What information do you need before deciding if friction is helpful or unhelpful?